

T U E S D A Y

PEACE:

A FRUIT OF LOVE

"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law."

Galatians 5:22, 23

Let's learn about fruit from around the World:

CRANBERRIES

The name cranberry is used to describe tart red berries produced by different plants. Fresh cranberries are stern, sour, and bitter. About 95% of cranberries are processed and used to make cranberry juice and sauce. Cranberry is widely used to promote overall health. It is especially beneficial to the eyes. They are also sold dried and sweetened. Cranberries are mostly grown and eaten in Canada, the United States, and Europe. The cranberries produced in Europe are smaller than the ones produced in North America.

Cranberry sauce is a traditional garnish at holiday dinners in the United Kingdom, the United States and Canada, especially at Thanksgiving dinners in the United States and Canada.

TODAY'S SPIRITUAL FRUIT IS

PEACE

In Galatians 5:22 and 23, the Apostle Paul says: “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, **peace**, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.”

It is important to realize that there is only one fruit; love. All the other good qualities listed in the text are parts of the fruit of love. Today's trait of love is peace, which like love is to be seen different from the desires of the flesh like “hostilities, strife, jealousy, outbursts of anger, selfish ambition, dissensions, factions.” (v. 20). To be sure, the contrast between peace and the list of bad deeds could not be more noticeable. They truly come from different sources and lead to separate ending points.

The problem Paul is writing about in the Galatian church is one we are still wrestling with today: the separation between works and faith. On the one hand believing we can live a good life if we try hard enough, or the understanding that living a life of freedom is only possible as a result of God working in us by His Spirit. The truth is, depending on our own strength will only lead to actions of the flesh, while the *fruit of the Spirit* is a sign that Christ lives in us. This proof is often shown in the peace that we have.

In Romans 12:18 Paul reminds us: “If possible, so far as it depends on you, be at peace with all people.” This passage finds the Apostle Paul speaking about the importance of loving even when one is being treated badly. In fact, in the previous verse (17) he tells us how the people of God—those filled with His Spirit—should behave: “Never repay evil for evil to anyone. Respect what is right in the sight of all people.” This, of course, includes how we should behave

with the members of our family; whether husband or wife, father or mother, daughter or son, sister or brother, aunt or uncle, cousin or grandparents; or any other person we are in relationship with.

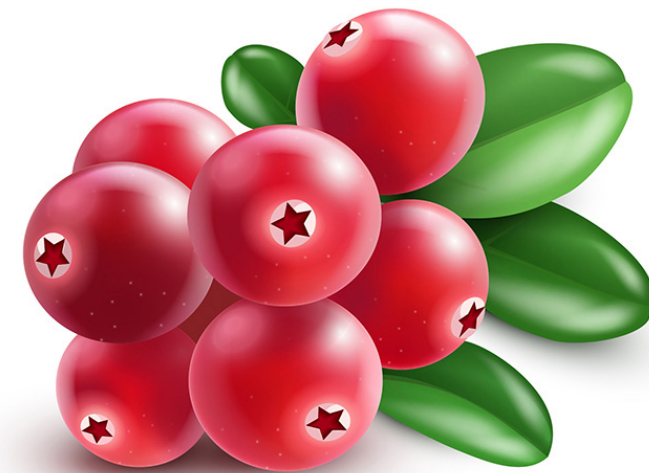
Paul makes clear, again, there is a difference in the behavior of the person led by the desires of the flesh and those who are controlled by the Spirit of God. Instead of hostility, anger and dissension, the person who is filled with God's Spirit will produce the fruit of love, displayed in a spirit of peace.

For the fruit of peace to be manifested in our lives each day, Ellen White in *Counsels for the Church* offers: “You need a daily baptism of the love that in the days of the apostles made them all of one accord...Surround your soul with an atmosphere that will strengthen spiritual life. Cultivate faith, hope, courage, and love. Let the peace of God rule in your heart” (*Counsels for the Church*, p. 175).

This kind of peace only comes as a result of being filled with the Spirit of God. So, today we encourage you to pick the fruit of peace not only about difficulties that you might be facing, but a relationship of peace with everyone in your family and others you are in relationship with.

PRAY:

Dear Heavenly Father, we ask for Your peace to be with us today. Help us to maintain a sense of Your presence and peace in our homes. May we find peace in every situation and circumstance as we always rely on You. In the name of Jesus, amen.



FRUITFUL **PEACE** ACTIVITY

You will need:

- A large piece of fabric, like a flat sheet or old tablecloth, to represent water
- A foam ball, sponge, or something light and unbreakable

Instructions:

- Read the story of Jesus calming the storm in Luke 8:22-25.
- Invite each person in the home to hold onto the piece of fabric, and imagine it is Lake Galilee.
- Practice making the fabric lake very still and calm, then very rough, by making big ripples in the fabric, and then calming the lake down by pulling the fabric tight again.
- Add the foam ball or sponge to the center of the fabric lake and pretend that it is the boat containing Jesus and the disciples.
- Then ask one of the children to retell the story of Jesus calming the storm. Ripple the cloth to make the stormy waves, and then pull the fabric tight again to calm the lake when Jesus commands the waves to be peaceful and still.
- Wonder together: How do you think the disciples felt before the storm, during the storm, and then when Jesus calmed the wind and waves? How do you think Jesus felt before the storm, during the storm and after it? What do each of you like best in this story? What is the most important message in the story for each of you? What does this story help us to understand about peace?
- Alternatively, half fill a plastic soda bottle with water. Tint it blue with a little food coloring, a drop of ink, or some paint. Add a cork or small piece of wood to the bottle to make a boat. Seal the bottle, turn it on its side, and use this bottle to illustrate the calm water, the stormy seas, and the peace after the storm.

BIBLE VERSE ACTIVITY

You will need:

- Cardstock, watercolor paper or heavy paper
- Crayons or painting supplies (paints, brushes, water, etc.)
- Or find a picture of a peaceful scene in a magazine or picture calendar.

Instructions:

- Cut out, or create with your art materials, a peaceful scene, perhaps with still water, flowers and trees.
- Use the picture or your artwork as a background and write the Bible verse on the picture to remind you of the peace that comes from God.
- Put the verse picture where your family will see it often or give it to someone who needs to experience God's peace.

— **QUESTIONS** — TO TALK ABOUT TOGETHER

- Being peaceful is a fruit of the Spirit because...
- Jesus helped people to experience peace by...
- Some Bible characters who were peacemakers were...
- Some things that make me feel peaceful are...
- It is hard for me to feel peaceful when...
- I was a peacemaker (I stopped an argument) this week when I...
- I experienced peace in a difficult situation this week when...
- We could experience more peace in our family by...
- Pray: Thank You, God, that we experienced peace this week when...